planks: raise the productivity of agriculture with more crop per acre of land and more crop per drop of water; provide remunerative prices to incentivize farmers; and expand irrigation by expanding groundwater irrigation.

High-yielding varieties (HYVs) and later hybrids, nourished by fertilizers, along with the increasing use of farm equipment, helped raise farm productivity. These are the technologies that brought the green revolution to India.

To provide remunerative prices to farmers, the Indian government initiated the system of minimum support prices or MSPs in 1965. Under the system, farmers were delivered a minimum assured return/profit on agriculture as the MSP was fixed after taking into account the farmer's cost of cultivation, an imputed value for labour contributed and a profit margin. The system succeeded in incentivizing farmers at least in parts of India where foodgrain cultivation became commercial agriculture.

Expansion of groundwater irrigation provided the much needed water to foodgrain crops. Well irrigation proved far more efficient than canal-based surface irrigation, which required massive investment, large displacements and water transportation over long distances.

India's Wheat Revolution

India produced 16.5 million tonnes of wheat in 1968, an increase of 45 per cent over the previous year's crop of 11.4 million tonnes.

This revolution was engendered by the Indian crossbred variety Sonalika, which was developed in 1967 and planted on a massive scale in 1967–68. The seeds of this spectacularly performing variety were sown in 1963 when celebrated American agronomist Norman Borlaug visited India and agreed to supply seeds of Mexican semi-dwarf wheat varieties to the country. Indian scientists, actively supported by the government, worked hard and successfully demonstrated the suitability of Mexican seeds for high-yield wheat in India. They also bred Indian varieties crossing Mexican